

3. Deposit checks into your bank account via your phone camera.
4. Sending money internationally is easy (GlobalRemit and Remitly).
5. Oh, and yes, ATMs are convenient for those who still use cash.

I'll stop there.

If you have yet to recognize this is the golden age of innovation for investors and financial transactions, it's because this remains an outlier opinion. But even that short list above makes it clear how much we have progressed. Gradually, then suddenly.

You might not have noticed these gradual improvements, but to your grandparents they are so futuristic as to seem alien.

Changes compound, just as surely as dollars do. This mathematical sleight of hand occurs slightly faster than a geologic pace. This is how the world changes.

“Gradually, then suddenly.” Perhaps that should be the mantra of investors.



People tend to overuse anecdotes and narratives to argue points better analyzed using data. But some anecdotes can lead us to ideas we might have overlooked. That is where we go next.

[168](#) Ernest Hemingway, *The Sun Also Rises* (Charles Scribner's Sons, 1926).

[169](#) Paul Volcker, “Think More Boldly,” *The Wall Street Journal* (December 14, 2009).